

The CEO Checklist

If you are about to sign - stop and ask these questions

Use this page when an SAP order form, RISE agreement, add-on, AI subscription or SI statement of work is on the table. Every question must be answered with a document or a number - not a slide.

#	Question to answer before signing
☐ 1	What exact business problem are we solving, and who in the business signed the requirement?
☐ 2	What does standard SAP already provide in our release, and what do we already own?
☐ 3	What exact licence, metric, quantity and term are we committing to - and which clause lets us reduce or convert it?
☐ 4	What happens to this commitment if automation removes 25% of transactional user activity during the term?
☐ 5	What will our AI consumption cost per year, at what fixed rate, with what cap?
☐ 6	Which responsibilities stay with us under this contract, according to the Roles and Responsibilities document?
☐ 7	Is our master data - materials, suppliers, equipment, hierarchy - ready for what this investment assumes?
☐ 8	What is the five-year and seven-year TCO, compared on the same basis with the alternatives?
☐ 9	Where will our data live, who can access it, can it train vendor models, and how do we get it back?
☐ 10	How do we exit, what does it cost, and who has independently challenged the SI's scope and estimate?

Value protection conditions - evidenced before signature

Condition	Evidence
☐ Requirement validated	Signed business requirement
☐ Standard capability mapped	Fit-gap with SAP references
☐ Existing licence mapped	Entitlement and usage report
☐ Duplicate capability checked	Capability map across owned products
☐ Product overlap checked	Overlap analysis
☐ Architecture validated	Architecture decision record
☐ Data readiness assessed	Data maturity assessment
☐ AI readiness assessed	Use-case pilot results and controls
☐ Integration cost assessed	Interface inventory and cost
☐ Customisation cost assessed	Custom code estimate and clean core level
☐ BTP cost assessed	Consumption forecast
☐ AI Unit cost assessed	Rate, forecast, cap, expiry
☐ SI effort challenged	Independent estimate review
☐ Five-year TCO calculated	TCO model
☐ Seven-year TCO calculated	TCO model incl. renewal and upgrade
☐ Exit strategy defined	Exit plan and contract clauses
☐ Governance approved	Steering committee minute

JM ETA ADVISORY PRINCIPLE

PROVE THE NEED. PROVE THE STANDARD. PROVE THE LICENCE. PROVE THE ARCHITECTURE. PROVE THE VALUE. THEN SPEND.